For founders who registered as a cosmetics responsible seller in Korea this year

Newly registered brand? Your safety assessment may not start in 2031

Newly registered = registered on or after Dec 30, 2025 (draft rules)

Group	Starts	All products
Existing, under KRW 1bn	2029 infants & children	2031
KRW 1bn+ or newly registered	2028 functional	2031

Find your start year with 3 questions →

Easy to miss

The earlier schedule is not only for KRW 1bn+ businesses

The draft amendments published by Korea's Ministry of Food and Drug Safety (MFDS) on July 8 define the group that starts first as:

Businesses with annual production or imports of KRW 1 billion or more,
or businesses registered on or after December 30, 2025

Even with small sales, a newly registered business should check the earlier schedule first.

Source: Cosinkorea · Cosmorning, Jul 8, 2026 (MFDS draft notice)

Draft schedule

What applies to each group, and when

Year	KRW 1bn+ or newly registered	Existing, under KRW 1bn
2028	Functional cosmetics (reviewed or reported after Dec 30, 2025)	—
2029	Cosmetics for infants and children	Cosmetics for infants and children
2030	Cosmetics first manufactured or imported after Dec 30, 2025	—
2031	All products	All products

Dec 30, 2025 is when Korea's amended Cosmetics Act was promulgated. As of Oct 16, the Enforcement Rule amendments are not yet promulgated (draft), so the schedule may change when finalized.

Source: MFDS Notice No. 2026-331 · Cosinkorea · Cosmorning, Jul 8

Find your brand's start year

Answer three questions

1. **Registered on or after Dec 30, 2025?**
   Based on the business (manufacturer or responsible-seller) registration date

2. **Annual production or imports of KRW 1bn+?**
   If either answer is 'yes', you are in the earlier group

3. **What type is your first product?**
   Functional / for infants and children / general cosmetic

> **Examples under the draft rules** · Registered in 2026 + whitening functional serum → **2028**
> · Registered in 2026 + general cream → **2030**
> · Registered in 2022, KRW 300M a year, general cosmetics → **2031**

What to do now

The data sits with the manufacturer, the responsibility with the responsible seller

Under the draft, safety assessment records are prepared for each product and kept **until one year after the expiry date or for three years from the date of manufacture or import**. They cover ingredient composition, toxicity, impurities, directions for use and adverse events.

Most ingredient information sits with the manufacturer. When you commission a new product, **write down at the contract or ordering stage how much of the ingredient data needed for the assessment you will receive.**

The industry expects a cost of at least about KRW 10 million per product (Herald Economy, Jul 2025). Factor it in before adding more products.

Source: MFDS Notice No. 2026-331 · Cosinkorea Jul 8 · Herald Economy Jul 2025

Summary

Three things to check now

1. **Your business registration date**
   Before December 30, 2025, or on/after that date

2. **Annual production or imports**
   KRW 1 billion or more?

3. **Your first product type**
   Functional · for infants and children · general

> Under the draft rules, these three determine your proposed start year.
> **Next post: ingredient data to request from your manufacturer in advance**